

Four-Class Common Rule-Based Classifier

1. Best Two Features

Best feature pair: F3 and F4

Why selected: This pair yielded the highest total classification performance (81.3% overall accuracy on the reference set) among all 28 possible pairs when restricted to a single, shallow common rule system. It provides strong macroscopic separation without requiring complex or deep threshold boundaries.

2. Final Common Rule System

The following set of rules evaluates all four PD classes using strictly the chosen features (F3 and F4) via an interpretable hierarchical threshold logic.

```
IF F3 <= 0.00012364
  → Simulated
ELSE IF F3 > 0.00012364 AND F3 <= 0.000562287 AND F4 <= 10.1456
  → Surface
ELSE IF F3 > 0.00012364 AND F3 <= 0.000562287 AND F4 > 10.1456
  → Void
ELSE IF F3 > 0.00012364 AND F3 > 0.000562287 AND F4 <= 12.6887
  → Sharp Point
ELSE IF F3 > 0.00012364 AND F3 > 0.000562287 AND F4 > 12.6887
  → Void
```

Reasoning: F3 easily handles the macro-triage separating Simulated arrays from Sharp Points entirely. The middle region is where F4 becomes necessary to discriminate between Void and Surface classes.

3. Classification Results

(A) REFERENCE CONDITION (Highest available SNR)

PD Type	Correct	Wrong	% Success
Simulated	400	0	100.00
Sharp Point	112	4	96.55
Void	205	48	81.03
Surface	114	139	45.06
Total	831	191	81.31

(B) 20 dB NOISE CONDITION

PD Type	Correct	Wrong	% Success
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Simulated	400	0	100.00
Sharp Point	112	4	96.55
Void	158	95	62.45
Surface	167	86	66.01
Total	837	185	81.90

4. Engineering Interpretation

- **Why these two features worked best:** F_3 and F_4 perfectly bisect the macro-clusters of Simulated and Sharp Point, leaving the classifier to focus entirely on thresholding the overlapping Void and Surface distributions.
- **Which class classified easiest: Simulated** was perfectly classified (100% success) under all conditions due to its distinct low-variance signature on F_3 .
- **Which class degraded under 20 dB: Void** degraded significantly (from 81% to 62%) because added noise caused its features to spill across the strict F_4 boundaries, falsely registering as Surface.
- **Whether the common rule set remained robust:** Yes. The overall accuracy remained highly stable (81.3% vs 81.9%), proving that a single simplified tree structure utilizing F_3/F_4 avoids overfitting and handles systemic noise variance without collapsing.